

North Carolina Mental Health & Substance Use Services Workforce Data 2024 Snapshot:

MENTAL HEALTH & SUBSTANCE USE SERVICES NURSE PRACTITIONERS

3,605

MH/SU Prescribers

Active Practice, Mental Health & Substance Use Services Prescribers

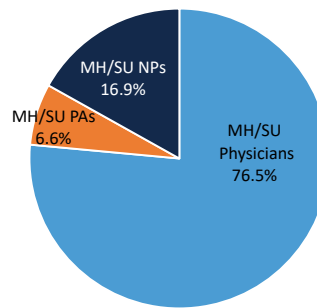
1,461

MH/SU NPs

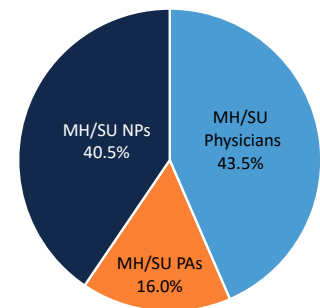
Mental Health & Substance Use Services Nurse Practitioners

- The average rate for MH/SU NPs in-state was **1.33 per 10,000** population.
- MH/SU NP supply **increased notably**, from 0.28 per 10,000 population in 2014.
- MH/SU NPs comprised **40.5% of the MH/SU prescriber group** in North Carolina in 2024.

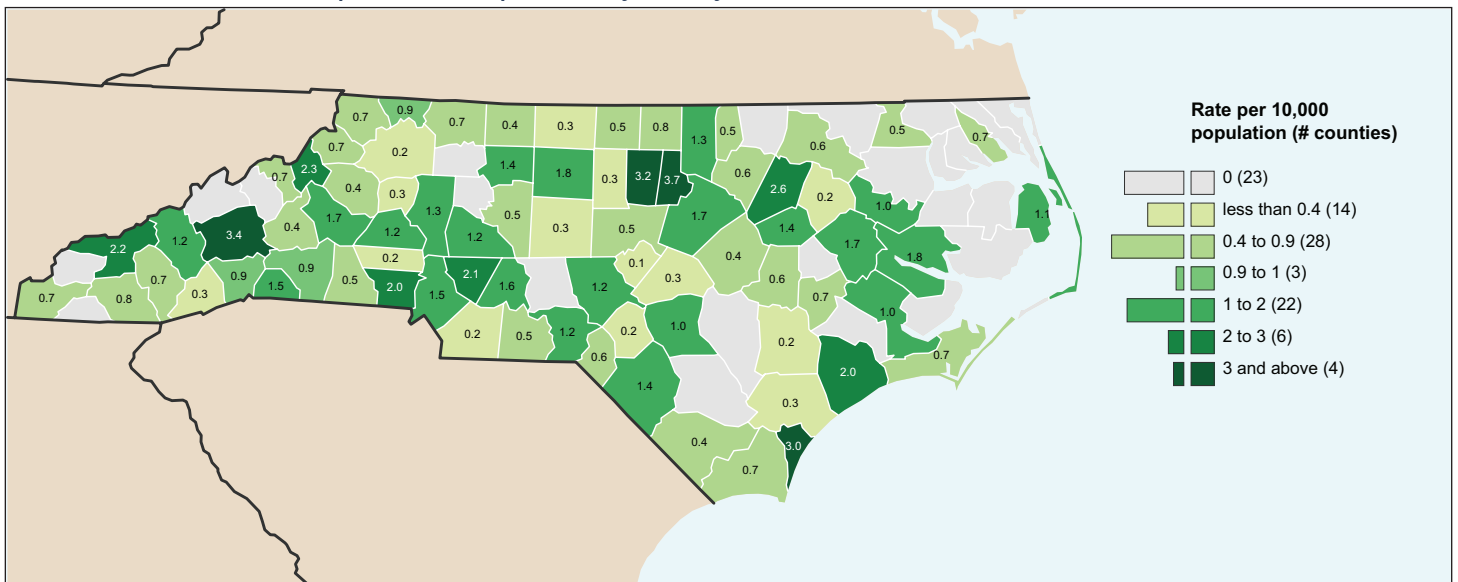
2014



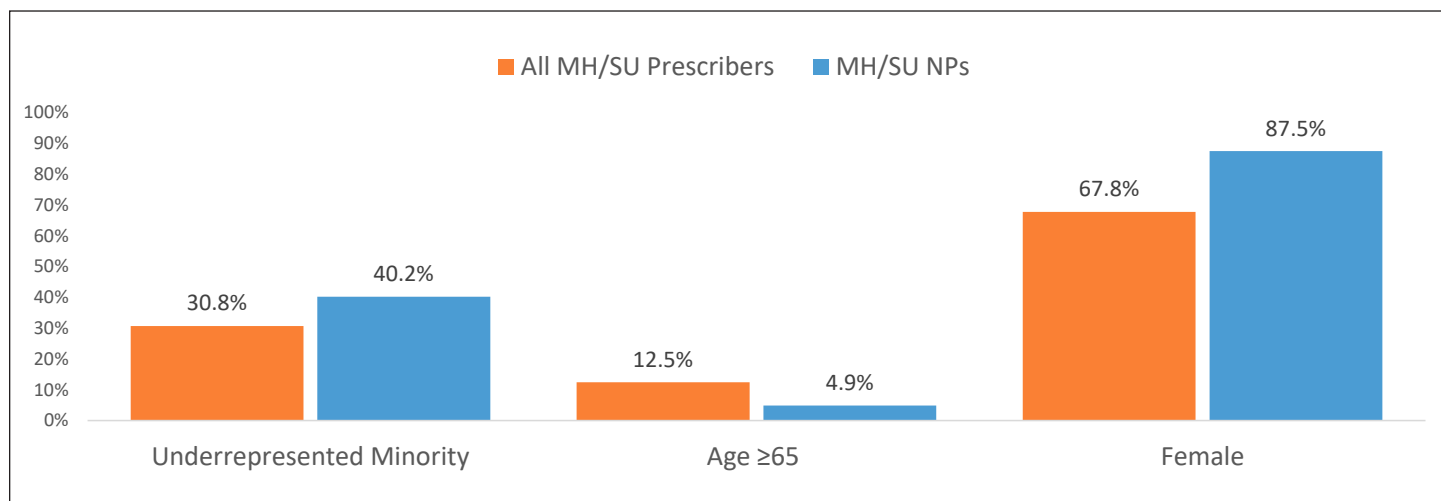
2024



MH/SU Nurse Practitioners per 10,000 Population by County, North Carolina, 2024



Demographics of MH/SU Prescribers, MH/SU NPs, and MH/SU Registered Nurses (RNs)

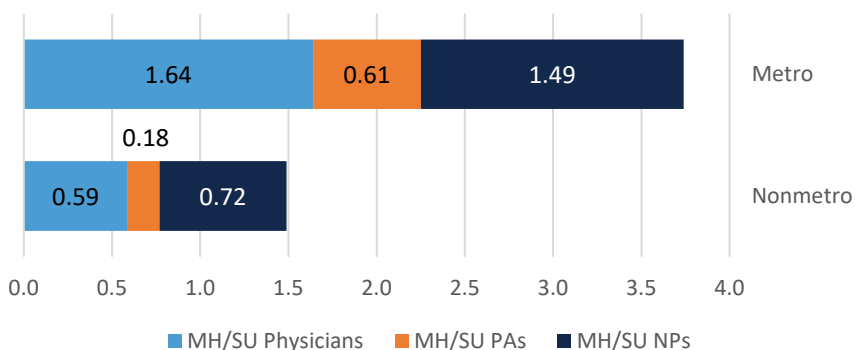


Demographics, 2024

MH/SU Nurse Practitioners:

- 87.5% female
- 4.9% ≥ 65 years
- 40.2% underrepresented minority

MH/SU Prescribers, MH/SU PAs, and MH/SU NPs Rate per 10k in Metro and Nonmetro Counties, 2024



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The state average was **1.33 MH/SU NPs per 10,000 population** with wide variability across counties.
- 23 counties had **no MH/SU NPs**. More than **75% of counties were lower** than the state average.
- **Metro counties had double the rate of MH/SU NPs** vs nonmetro counties: 1.49 vs 0.72 per 10,000.
- The supply of MH/SU NPs in NC increased since 2014 and became similar in size to the MH/SU physician workforce in 2024.
- MH/SU NPs had a higher representation of females and underrepresented minorities than the other MH/SU prescriber types.

For more information, please find the full report at: <https://nchealthworkforce.unc.edu/projects/mhsu-workforce/>



NC DEPARTMENT OF
**HEALTH AND
HUMAN SERVICES**
Division of Mental Health,
Developmental Disabilities and
Substance Use Services

**SHEPS HEALTH
WORKFORCE NC**

This project was supported by the NC Department of Health and Human Services, Division of Mental Health, Developmental Disabilities and Substance Use Services (DMHDDSUS). The information, content and conclusions are those of the authors and should not be construed as the official position or policy of, nor should any endorsements be inferred by DMHDDSUS.

NCDHHS is an equal opportunity employer and provider.

